



iCloud non-public relay

The iOS 15.3 replace launch will repair iCloud non-public relay warnings on T-cellular plans. <https://digit.in/feb22-58>



Microsoft employees leave

Microsoft have let go of nearly 70 personnel who worked on its HoloLens AR Headset. <https://digit.in/feb22-59>



BLACKBERRY: END & THE BEGINNING

The OG smartphones that paved the way for all generations and more

Deeksha Devadiga |
feedback@digit.in

E

veryone at some point in their life either had a BlackBerry or wanted one. They were beautiful

looking devices with QWERTY keyboards – not the on-screen versions you see now, actual physical keyboards. BlackBerry and their devices went through a raft of changes over the years, but except

right at the very end, they stayed true to the physical keyboard that they were known for. Sadly, that itself might have been their Achilles' heel. The reason we're reminiscing about BlackBerry, however, is because all those old BlackBerry phones you might have lying about are now history. BlackBerry announced a shutdown of their smartphone services early in 2022. Funnily enough, that should actually raise the value of your old BlackBerry phones! As a way of bidding BlackBerry adieu, we decided to write what will (perhaps) be the last ever BlackBerry feature article to appear in Digit! Enjoy the tip down memory lane.

THE BEGINNING: 1996- 2005

Formerly known as Research in Motion, BlackBerry started with

interactive pagers in 1996 and later in 1999 introduced the BlackBerry 850, which was the first handheld device on could access email on, and included a two-way pager and a thumb wheel for scrolling. The 850 series included the model 850, 857, 900, 950, 957 and 962 devices.

It was the 5000 and 6000 series that first featured mobile calling capability, and had java inbuilt. The added benefits of text messaging, Internet faxing, Web browsing and other wireless information services sweetened the deal, but the email services are what took the corporate world by storm, and made a BlackBerry the most sought after cellphone. Over the initial few years the monochromatic display kept varying with their sizes. The switch from headsets to integrated calling was witnessed and at the same time the manufacturing of the navigation bar kept changing sides. Another major update came with Bluetooth, which was introduced in the BlackBerry 7290 from the 7000 series in 2004. The same series were the first colour models, a switch from the monochrome look. The 7000 series also had a major change from their



regular look of QWERTY keyboard, they had a QWERTY look-alike but with two letters per button to give the cellphone a more slim look. These models were pushed for consumer buying rather than just for business.

THE BUILD : 2005- 2011

It was the 8000 series that most of us will remember, as they were the most popular. It had the original full QWERTY Keypad, an updated